



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

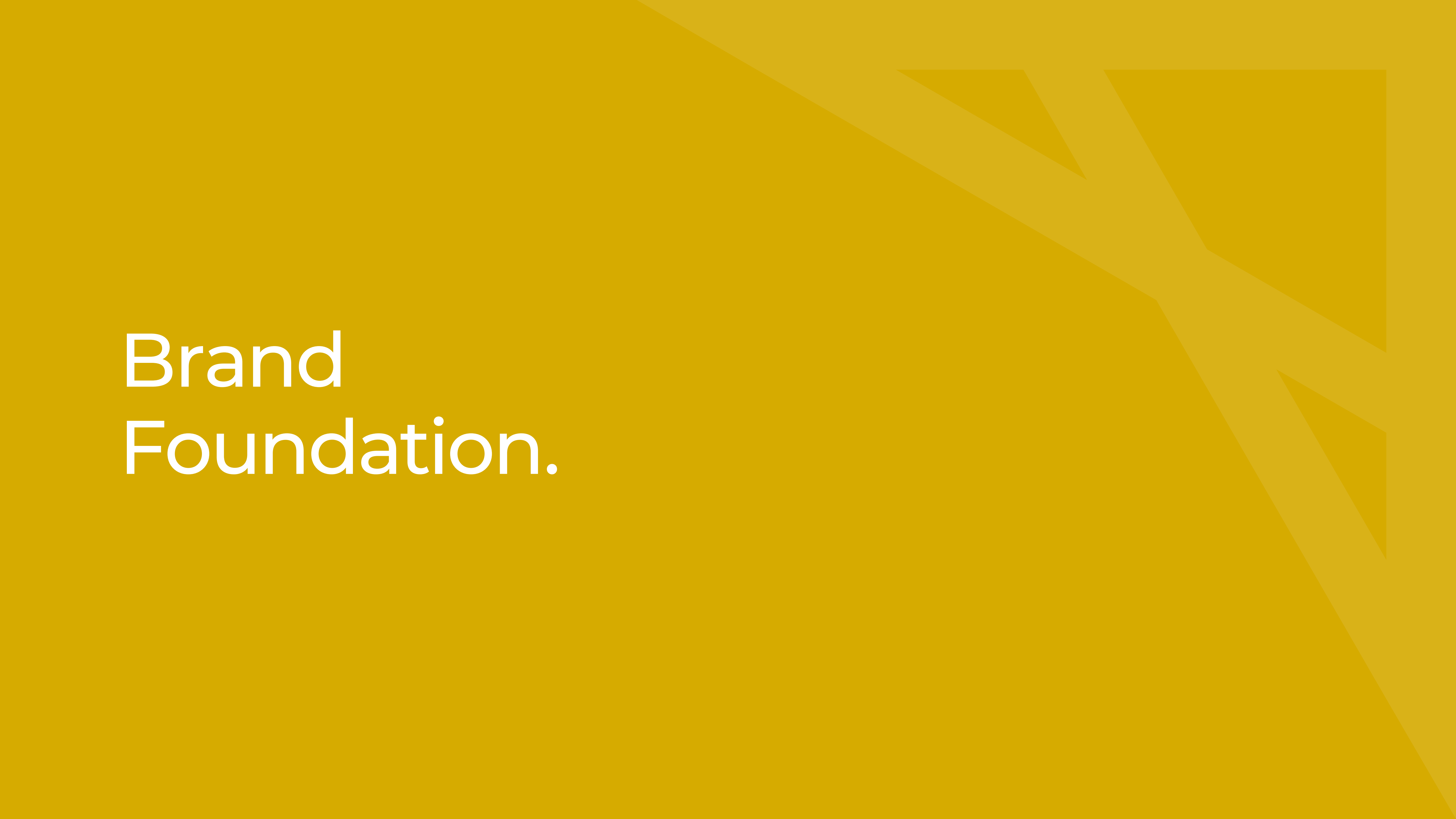
Brand Identity Guide.

Last Updated: September 2025



Contents.

Brand Foundation	03
Brand Voice	08
Visual Elements	12
Colours	20
Typography	23
Graphic Styles	30
Photography	33
Sub-Brands	38



Brand
Foundation.

Our Approach

The Alliance's principles create a clear sense of purpose and direction. They shape every aspect of who we are. We hold them at our very core.

Collective Genius

A foundation of brain power, expertise and collaboration that fosters ingenuity and purpose-driven communication.

Uncompromising Integrity

With an unwavering commitment to the highest standard of quality, we foster a sense of individual accountability and responsibility on our journey to achieve results.

Transformational

We are transforming the future through our ground-breaking collaborative approach by acting as an accelerator of change and discovery.

Diverse & Inclusive

We support and enable equal access to underserved research communities.

Our Vision

This is the reason for a brand to exist.
What drives us is our passion for accelerating
research discoveries.

To catalyze world-class
Canadian research for
the benefit of all.

Our Mission

This is the Alliance's statement of commitment —
a pledge to stakeholders about what they can expect
from every interaction with us, and the long-lasting
relationships we build.

As a trusted and inclusive partner, the
Digital Research Alliance of Canada
fosters national and global collaboration to
provide researcher-centric, sustainable and
integrated digital research infrastructure.

Tagline: Accelerating Canada's Research Future.

Guiding Principles

These are the fundamental strengths that enable us to deliver value to our stakeholders, and position ourselves as a trusted and inclusive partner. It is what we do and how we do it.

What we do

Researcher-Centric

Supports researchers by understanding and meeting DRI needs.

Service-Oriented

Ensures a comprehensive set of services combined with meeting specialized requirements.

Striving for Excellence

Enables ecosystem excellence through best practices and maintenance of standards.

How we do it

Accountable & Transparent

Builds and maintains trust of the community.

Collaborative

Partners and works in co-operation with the Canadian Digital Research Infrastructure (DRI) ecosystem and internationally.

Diverse & Inclusive

Supports and enables equal access to underserved research communities.

Inclusive Messaging

Inclusive boilerplate messaging based on our key pillars should be used with frequency and consistency in all marketing, human resources, website applications and social media presence.

Researcher-Centric

- We work to understand researcher DRI needs today and in the future.
- We anticipate DRI needs by constantly monitoring the national and global research landscape.
- We are committed to ensuring that researchers across all disciplines have fair and equitable access to DRI.
- We deliver a seamless, one-door access point to integrated DRI services that places researchers at the centre.

Service-Oriented

- We provide a focused suite of services with broad, pan-Canadian applicability.
- We work with our partners to build out broader or specialized services to meet specific needs.
- We ensure cohesive integration among research software, advanced computing and data management.

Striving for Excellence

- We are transforming how DRI is designed, funded, maintained and delivered.
- We are committed to setting and maintaining the highest DRI standards to support research excellence.
- DRI is a rapidly evolving set of technologies and processes, and we invest in best practices, education and training.
- We strive to balance national research priorities with individual research needs.

Accountable & Transparent

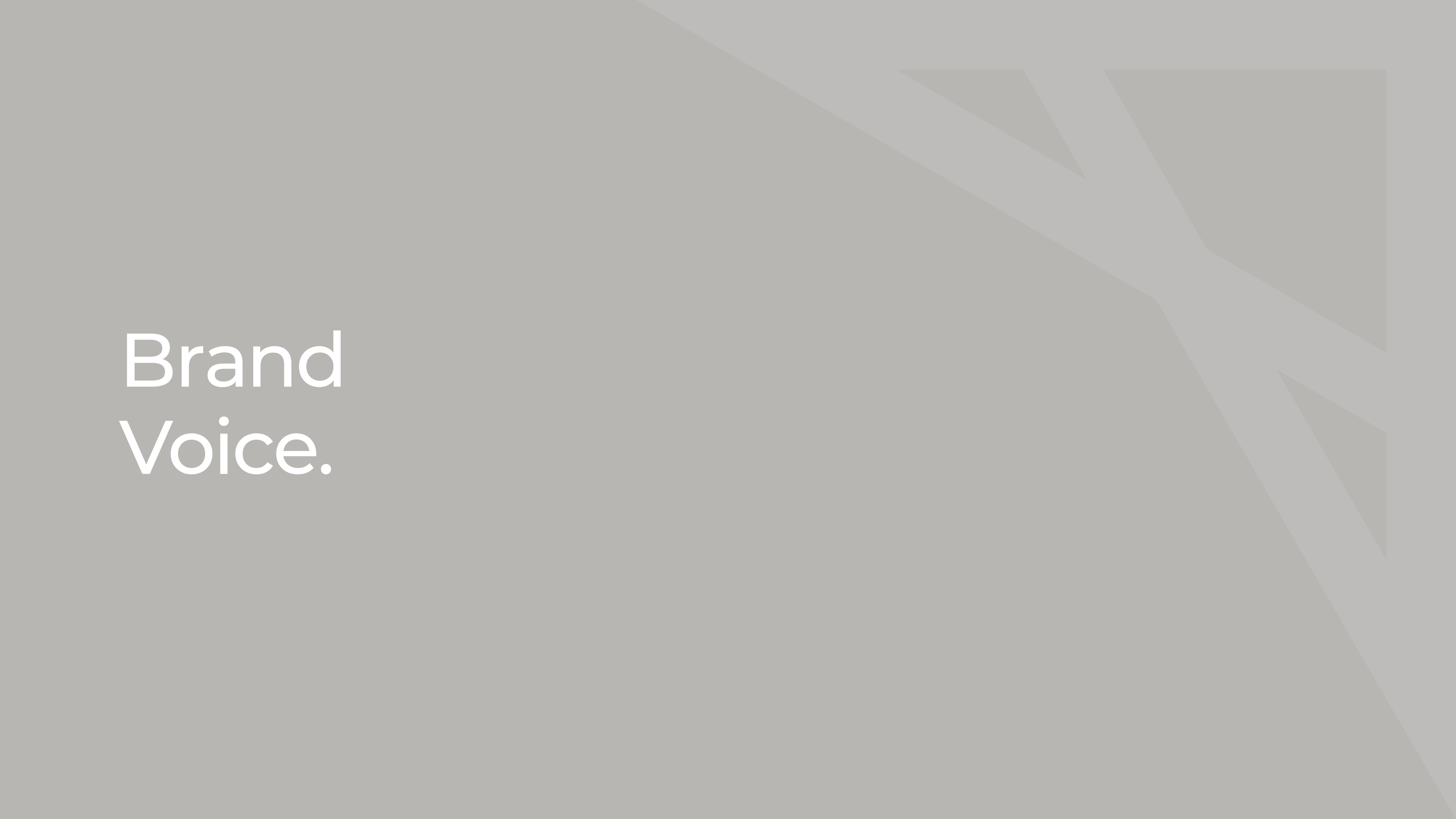
- We are transparent in everything we do.
- We are accountable to all of our stakeholders, including the Canadian public.
- We are open and honest stewards of Canada's DRI.
- We invest wisely, responsibly and strategically to maintain a dynamic, responsive and reliable DRI ecosystem.

Collaborative

- Collaboration in research and DRI is vital to meeting the urgency and complexity of research today.
- We work within Canada's DRI ecosystem to accelerate research, discovery and understanding.
- Provinces and territories are vital partners in the success of the DRI ecosystem.
- Industry and international partners are a vital part of Canada's future DRI landscape.

Diverse & Inclusive

- We will ensure fair and equitable access to DRI for traditionally underserved research communities.
- We collaborate with First Nations, Inuit, Métis and other Indigenous Peoples in Canada to support Indigenous data sovereignty.



Brand
Voice.

Voice Principles

Our brand voice guides our brand's expression - it is how we engage with the world, shaping a distinctive and personal brand experience.

Human & Genuine

Using words that are clear, simple and natural. Phrasing communication to sound like a typical conversation. The result is a tone that is genuine and accessible.

Passionate & Energetic

Use language and tone that will infuse statements with the inherent passion that we and all of our stakeholders share. Passion is contagious and the writing should convey that.

Visionary & Smart

The Alliance is a visionary organization and the words used in all material should support that. Statements like Accelerating Canada's Research Future and Accelerating Discoveries, support this.

Informative & Clear

Always inform but without the jargon. Speak to benefits. There is a wealth of information that should be shared while still following the "Human & Genuine" principle.

Brand Story

Our brand story is a cohesive narrative that encompasses the **core tangibles** of why we exist: computers, data, software, facilities, infrastructure — the **rational benefits** we provide: national perspective and strategy, partnerships, open access, integration, open data, planning for the future, informed investments, international presence, advocacy — as well as the **emotional rewards** that can be felt: shared goals, better understanding of our world, benefiting all life, realized potential, collaboration, community, fairness, opportunity.

Together, our brand story positions the Alliance as an accelerator of change and discovery.

From discovering insulin to fighting climate change to examining social inequity and beyond, Canada's researchers have collaboratively tackled some of humanity's biggest challenges. Today, research is increasingly urgent, complex and interconnected, and in response our researchers need better access to data sharing, specialized software and advanced computing power.

The Digital Research Alliance of Canada is accelerating discovery by transforming how digital research infrastructure is designed, managed, sustained and delivered to Canada's researchers and their global collaborators. Investing with vision, planning for the future, improving access to integrated digital research infrastructure and collaborating with a network of partners are all at the heart of what we do.

We both lead and serve, bringing a cohesive pan-Canadian vision for DRI and a passion to collaboratively support our brilliant research community as they ask questions, gain understanding, accelerate discovery and transform how we live in our world.

Accelerating Canada's Research Future.

CP Style

Unless specifically otherwise noted, the Alliance follows the Canadian Press Stylebook for all written communications.

The Canadian Press style guide provides authoritative advice on writing and editing from Canada's national news agencies. Whether you are in journalism, communications, publishing or public relations, ensure your writing is accurate and consistent by following the standards set out by Canada's trusted news leaders.

The online edition of the CP Stylebook is available via subscription at

www.thecanadianpress.com/writing-guide/



Visual
Elements.

Logo

Bilingual – Horizontal

This is the default logo that should be used on signage, marketing collateral and promotional material.



Bilingual – Stacked

This alternative logo variation can be used in applications when the horizontal logo does not fit.



Logo

Continued.

Unilingual Variations

English-only and French-only variations of the logo are only appropriate for unilingual materials.



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada



**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Bilingual – Tagline



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Accelerating Canada's
Research Future.

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Accélérer l'avenir de
la recherche au Canada.



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Accelerating Canada's
Research Future.

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Accélérer l'avenir de
la recherche au Canada.

Logo Rules

Safe Space

In order to maximize its visual presence, the logo requires a surrounding area clear of any other graphic elements or text.

This minimum safe area is built upon the size of the the upper-case 'A' found in the word 'Alliance.' Always use this reference amount to create sufficiently clear space around the logo.



Minimum Size

In order to ensure that the Alliance logo is always legible, it must meet minimum size requirements.

Print: minimum 0.5" in height.

Digital: minimum 50 px in height.



Improper Logo Usage



Do not stretch, shrink or distort the logo



Do not blur the logo



Do not scale smaller than the minimum size



Do not change any of the logo's colours



Do not add additional design elements



Do not add drop shadows



Do not add gradient colours



Do not rotate or alter the alignment of the logo



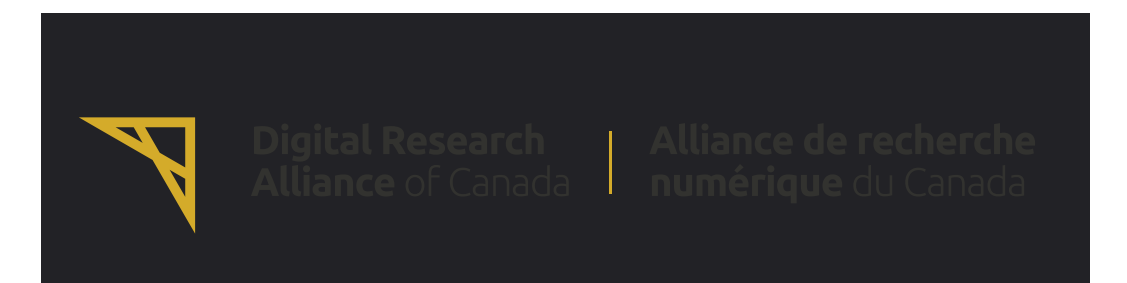
Do not alter the design of the logo



Do not use background colours that are not approved



Do not use on busy backgrounds



Do not use on low-contrast backgrounds

Arrow Symbol

Tomorrow's Arrow

The arrow symbol used in the Alliance logo represents a connected network of collaborators working in unison to accelerate research discoveries toward the future. For this reason, the arrow should always point forward, up and to the right, as shown here.

It can be used as part of the logo itself, or it can be used independently of the logo as a storytelling device or graphic element.



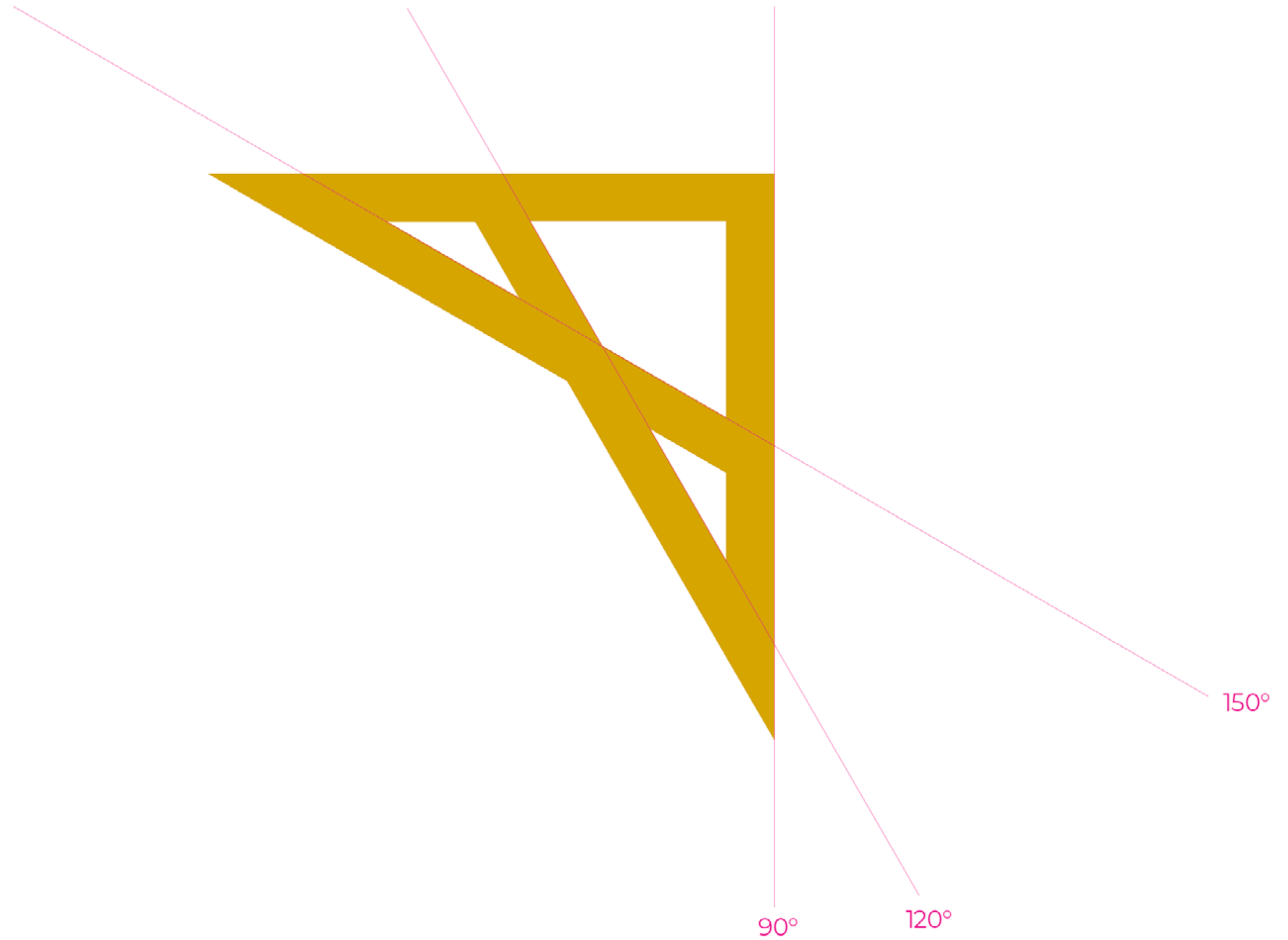
Crossing Lines

Story

The angles used in the arrow symbol can also be used to help tell a compelling story.

Rules

Ensure the use of angles, shown here, is always consistent whenever used as graphic elements or with cropping.



International Logo Variation

The Alliance has created a special logo variation featuring a maple leaf to emphasize our Canadian identity in global contexts.

Rules & Guidelines

This logo may be used only in international settings such as trade shows, conferences, global partnerships or other events outside of Canada. It should never replace the primary Alliance logo in domestic or internal communications.

Always use the approved artwork files and follow all standard logo rules for size, spacing and background colours. The maple leaf element must not be altered, recoloured or combined with other brand or partner logos.

The primary Alliance logo remains the default for all other uses.



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada 



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada 

The background features a dark gray field with several overlapping geometric shapes in varying shades of gray and black. These shapes include triangles, trapezoids, and irregular polygons, some of which are oriented diagonally, creating a layered, architectural effect.

Colours.

Colour Palette

Colour can have a powerful psychological effect on our emotions, perceptions and decisions.

A brand colour palette is crucial to building a successful corporate identity. The right colours used in the right way have the power to tell a compelling story, build brand recognition and recall, and make a lasting impression with key audiences.

Only these fresh and bright colours should be used in the Alliance's communications.



Colour Palette

Continued.

Primary colours

There are four colours in our primary colour palette. Even though the corporate palette uses these colours, it also relies on substantial use of white space to create a recognizable look that is clean, approachable and uncluttered.

Secondary colours

The secondary colours should be used sparingly to support public-facing communications to create visual interest. As with the primary palette, this palette also relies on substantial use of white space to convey a look that is clean, approachable and uncluttered. Tap into this palette for elements such as charts, graphs and illustrations, or as background colours to break up large sections of content that require a visual disruption.

Tertiary colours

The tertiary colours should be used sparingly to add depth and contrast in designs or where a larger colour palette for charts, graphs, illustrations, etc. is needed.



RGB 251, 250, 250
HEX #FBFAFA
PMS White
CYMK 1, 1, 1, 0



RGB 0, 102, 102
HEX #006666
PMS 7715
CYMK 90, 42, 55, 22



RGB 214, 171, 0
HEX #D6AB00
PMS 110
CYMK 18, 30, 100, 0



RGB 50, 50, 47
HEX #32322F
PMS Black 7
CYMK 69, 62, 65, 60



RGB 81, 190, 156
HEX #51BE9C
PMS 3265
CYMK 65, 0, 50, 0



RGB 183, 182, 179
HEX #B7B6B3
PMS Cool Grey 4
CYMK 29, 23, 26, 0



RGB 168, 228, 226
HEX #A8E4E2
PMS 317
CYMK 31, 0, 13, 0



RGB 243, 125, 83
HEX #F37D53
PMS 2024
CYMK 0, 63, 72, 0



RGB 179, 2, 26
HEX #B3021A
PMS 3517
CYMK 20, 100, 100, 13



Typography.

Primary Typefaces

The Alliance’s two primary typefaces are Ubuntu and Montserrat. Both offer flexibility in their weight variations and are widely available as free, open-source type options from Google Fonts.

To ensure consistency for all Alliance-related communications, please download or activate the fonts by following these links:

googlefonts.com/Ubuntu
googlefonts.com/Montserrat

(Please note: these are free licensed font families, perfect for CSS and Android, as well as print.)

Ubuntu

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890?!@#\$%^&*()-_+=

Aa

UBUNTU
LIGHT

Aa

UBUNTU
LIGHT ITALIC

Aa

UBUNTU
REGULAR

Aa

UBUNTU
REGULAR ITALIC

Aa

UBUNTU
MEDIUM

Aa

UBUNTU
MEDIUM ITALIC

Aa

UBUNTU
BOLD

Aa

UBUNTU
BOLD ITALIC

Primary Typefaces

Continued.

Montserrat

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890? !@#\$%^&* () - _ = +

Aa

MONTERRAT
THIN

Aa

MONTERRAT
THIN ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
EXTRA LIGHT

Aa

MONTERRAT
EXTRA LIGHT ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
LIGHT

Aa

MONTERRAT
LIGHT ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
REGULAR

Aa

MONTERRAT
ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
MEDIUM

Aa

MONTERRAT
MEDIUM ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
SEMIBOLD

Aa

MONTERRAT
SEMIBOLD ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
BOLD

Aa

MONTERRAT
BOLD ITALIC

Aa

MONTERRAT
BLACK

Aa

MONTERRAT
BLACK ITALIC

Alternate Typeface

The Alliance's secondary typeface is *Arial*, a free system font, which should only be used in applications where the primary typefaces are not available. This typeface was chosen for its universal availability across all platforms.

Arial

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890?!@#\$%^&*() -_ = +

Aa

ARIAL
REGULAR

Aa

ARIAL
REGULAR ITALIC

Aa

ARIAL
BOLD

Aa

ARIAL
BOLD ITALIC

Hierarchy Styling

These are the standard header styles that should be used across all applications. By applying the approved type scale, font weights and colours, we can ensure consistency across all formats and executions. Styling outside of this standard approach can be used for display purposes.

Start by establishing the body copy size (Step 1) to ensure proper readability and legibility, and then apply the formula provided here. This formula is used as a guide and can be slightly modified to accommodate space limitations.

H1—STEP 5 (2.375X)
UBUNTU MEDIUM

H2—STEP 4 (2X)
MONTERRAT LIGHT
(TEXT GREY)

H3—STEP 3 (1.25X)
MONTERRAT SEMIBOLD
(TEXT GREY)

H4—STEP 2 (0.8X)
MONTERRAT BOLD
(TEXT GREY)

BODY COPY—STEP 1 (1X)
MONTERRAT REGULAR
(TEXT GREY)

This is a first-level header

This is a second-level header

This is a third-level header

This is a fourth-level header

This is body copy. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.

Dividers

The divider is a design element that helps enforce layout spacing rules and ensures consistent padding between headlines and the content below them.

The divider is scalable — based on a predetermined value — allowing it to always maintain the desired distance, regardless of how the text size or layout changes. It should be used with a contrasting colour, such as ‘Tomorrow Yellow.’

Lorem ipsum dolor

Lorem ipsum
dolor sit amet

Lorem ipsum
dolor sit amet

Pull Quotes

Pull quotes are a visual device used to highlight important information while also breaking up large sections of on-page copy. The content within the pull quote should be compelling and succinct, and should represent a standalone idea that is easy to understand without additional context. There are two ways of displaying pull quotes:

Inline quote

Inline pull quotes are framed by a yellow quotation mark that identifies it as a quote and finalized by a horizontal line below it, ensuring it stands out from the rest of the copy in the layout.

Block quote

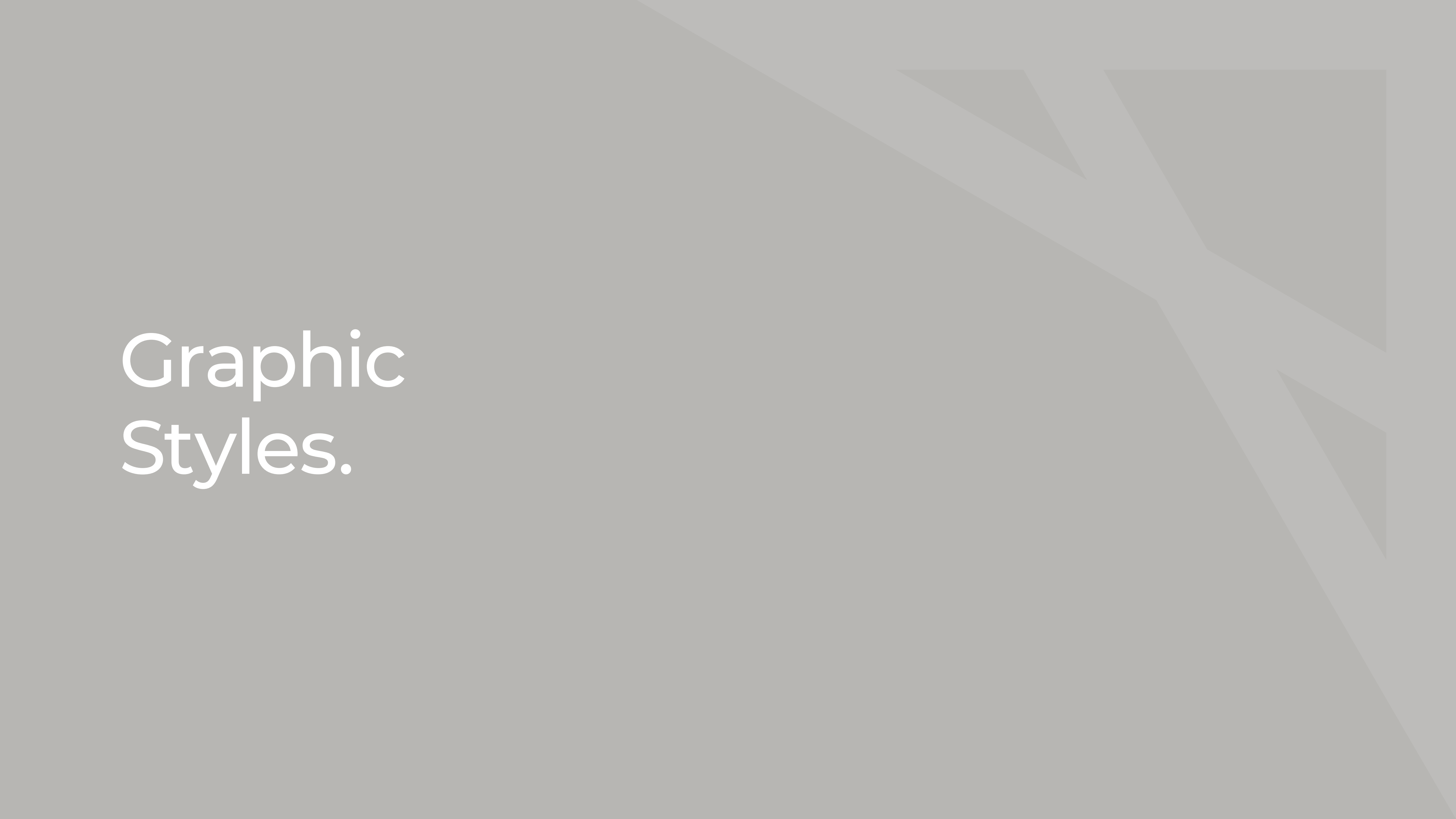
Block quotes are centered, surrounded by preserved space, on an image with a colour overlay. The colour overlay selected is flexible, but should always be used with a blending mode. Specific opacity levels can depend on the brightness and composition of the underlying image. Always ensure that images are dark enough to contrast with the text.



Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet
consectetur adipiscing elit.
Integer sit amet ipsum ut ligula
luctus vestibulum id lectus.”

— First Lastname, Title, Company





Graphic
Styles.

Iconography

Icons can be used to offer quick visual cues to help our audiences navigate content and understand complex topics. The iconographic style should strive to mirror the line thickness within the logo, to help reinforce a cohesive look and feel within the brand.

The icons should be used in vector or SVG formats to ensure they remain legible in varying sizes. They can be used in almost any brand colour (depending on the context in which they are used), as well as reversed (in white) when required for legibility.

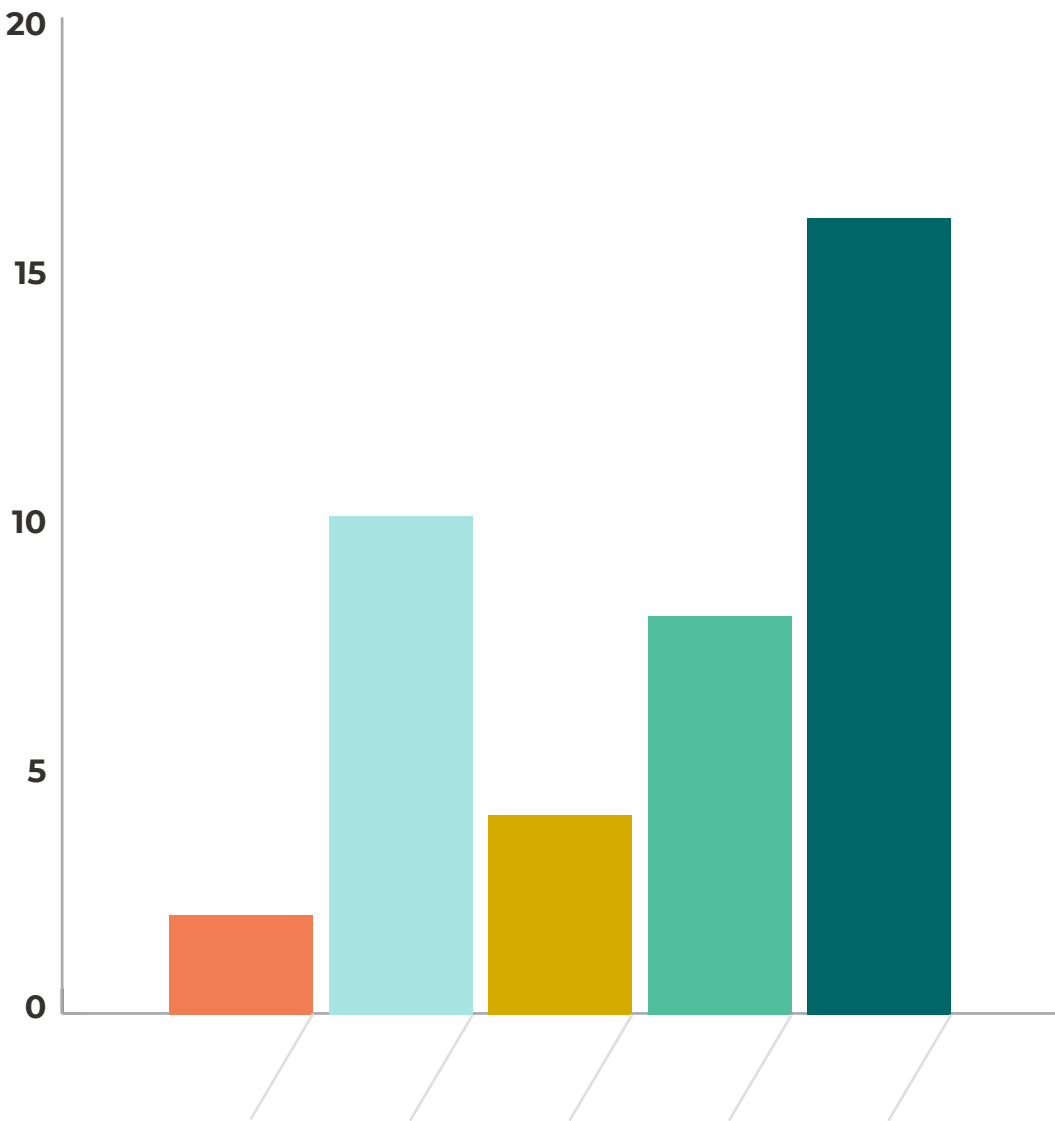
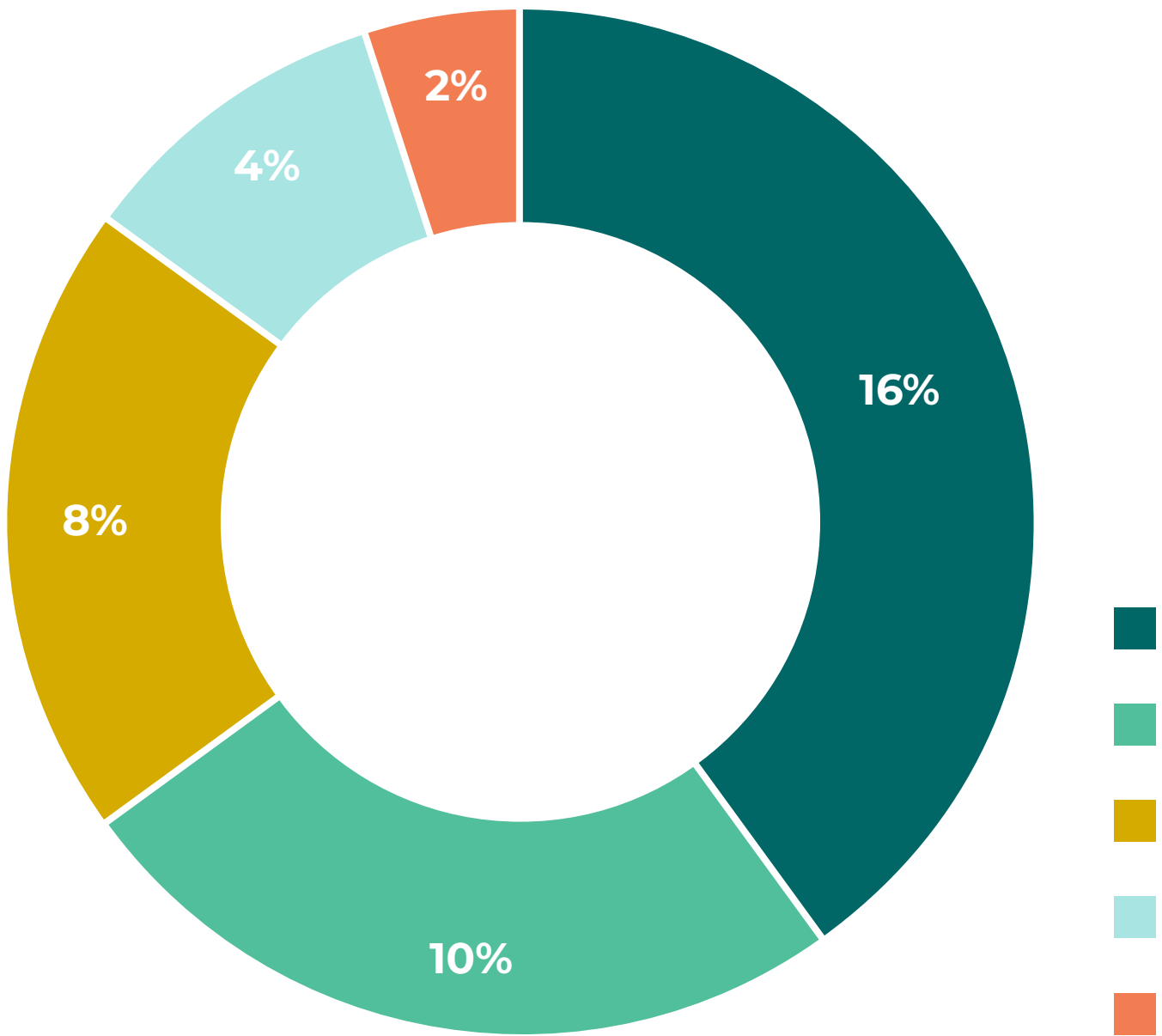
You can also find similar (open-source) icons at [google/icons.com](https://google.com/icons) or in any Microsoft software like PowerPoint and Word.



Graph Styles

These are some design examples for graphs and charts, which are used to quickly and easily represent numbers, statistics or relationships visually.

Every brand colour may be used to draw attention to the central statistic in each application. Since charts and graphs can range in complexity, the examples depicted here are intended as a reference only.



The background is a solid teal color. On the right side, there are several overlapping, semi-transparent geometric shapes in a slightly lighter shade of teal. These shapes include triangles and polygons, some of which are oriented diagonally, creating a modern, abstract design.

Photography.

Photography

Photography plays a crucial role in the Alliance's visual brand identity. It is a attention-grabbing storytelling device that quickly communicates complex ideas, emotions and experiences. Photography supports messaging, and when used consistently it can also act as an identifier and differentiator for the brand.



Photography Principles

There are a number of key principles that should be considered when choosing photography for the Alliance's branded material:

People

The photography should prioritize people and human interaction. Regardless of whether the image has a sole individual or a small group of people collaborating, it should show an experience or a facial expression that looks genuine and natural — not staged. This principle is meant to convey how people benefit from research in everyday life. When selecting images, considerations for diversity with gender, race and ability are a high priority for the Alliance.

Technology & Research

This photography principle should prioritize technology and research by either depicting researchers interacting with technology, or simply showcasing researchers doing their work, either in the field or in a controlled environment. Whenever possible, this principle should strive to convey collaboration. Technology itself can appear dated rather quickly, so the emphasis should always be on the interaction and the collaboration.

Canada

To convey Canada's contribution to research discoveries and how they benefit the world, this photography principle should strive to illustrate the areas of Canada impacted by research—whether it is the environment, advances in Canadian technology and engineering, weather, climate change, farming, architecture and so on. This principle is meant to be aspirational.

Photography Principles

Continued.

Harmonious Colours & Connections

Allow natural, harmonious colours to lighten, brighten and warm up photography in design elements.

Warmer tones, natural shades, and richer colours will elevate the energy of photography and will allow for more use of the extended colour palette in designs.

Photography that already incorporates brand colours is also a way to create harmony in design and build brand equity.

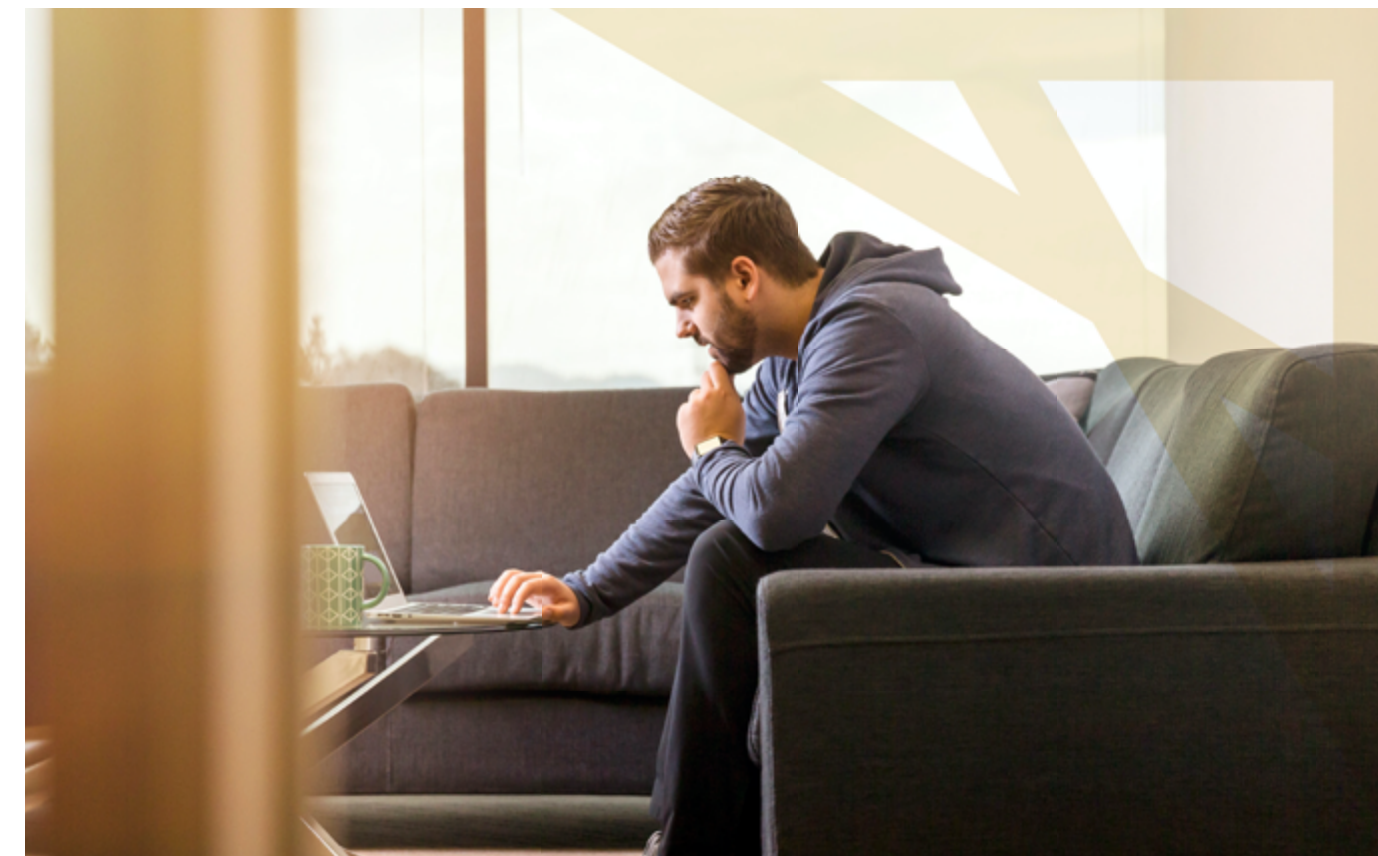
When showcasing Canada, photography should have a human element – either connecting with the landscape or with people.



Triangles & Typography

Consider leaning into solid triangular shapes and angles from the icon as design elements. The larger shapes give an opportunity to add free areas for type in presentations, posts, etc., without fighting with photography. It also allows for pops of brand colours in a creative and engaging way. The shapes could be used in solid or transparent colours.

Type can also be used as an enticing design element. Montserrat is a graphic typeface that lends well to bold messaging. Add a period to headings, titles and copy for brand consistency, as shown here.





Sub-Brands
& Partners.

Sub-Brands

The Alliance's products, services, campaigns, and initiatives should always be branded in a way that shows a clear visual relationship to the Alliance's core brand. This includes using the approved colour palette and typefaces, as well as identifying the Alliance as the parent organization.

Communications & Marketing must approve the creation of all sub-brands for campaigns, initiatives or programs. Approved sub-brands (e.g., Sovereign AI Compute) must always be paired with the Alliance logo to ensure a consistent connection to the overall brand.



Collaborative Projects

Projects on which the Alliance and its partners and/or stakeholder organizations work together should be co-branded to indicate collaboration, while still maintaining their respective identities.

Rules & Guidelines

The example shown here illustrates the approved lockup format for co-branded initiatives. In practice, the partner's logo should replace the sample logo displayed on the right.



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

canarie



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

canarie



Affiliates

Those who provide national infrastructure within the federation are encouraged to indicate their affiliation within the Alliance ecosystem with clear text and/or related visuals.

Rules & Guidelines

When identifying one's affiliation with the Alliance, please follow the structure provided with frequency and consistency. Digital graphic files are available for use in print, web, social media and presentations, in either English or French versions.

Affiliated with the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Affilié à

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Affiliated with the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Affilié à

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Members

Members of the Alliance's ecosystem are encouraged to indicate their membership with clear text and/or related visuals.

Rules & Guidelines

When identifying one's membership with the Alliance, please follow the provided structure with frequency and consistency. Digital graphic files are available for use in print, web, social media and presentations, in either English or French versions.

A **member** of the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Membre de l'

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

A **member** of the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Membre de l'

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Distributed Workforce

Members of the distributed workforce are encouraged to indicate their connection to the Alliance by using this logo variation.

Rules & Guidelines

When referencing a relationship with the Alliance, use this wordmark consistently. It may be applied across email signatures, print materials, social media, and presentations, in either English or French formats.

Supported by the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Soutien par

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada

Supported by the

**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

Soutien par

**Alliance de recherche
numérique** du Canada



**Digital Research
Alliance** of Canada

The Alliance brand is more than a logo, typeface, or colour palette — it reflects our commitment to collaboration, integrity and accelerating Canada's research future. By following these guidelines, you help ensure that every expression of our brand reinforces our shared mission and strengthens the community of researchers we serve.

alliancecan.ca